4. Several new initiatives were embarked upon and some existing practices improved to enhance the productivity and ability of the department to deliver on its mission.

a. Refurbishing of the BPR&D website to be the destination site for all issues relating to the training, research and development of police and correctional facilities. Feedback has been sought from members of the service. Appropriate changes will be incorporated keeping the best interests and needs of the service.

b. Issues dealing with the recruitment, training, welfare and promotion of BPR&D employees were prioritized and fast-tracked for resolution.

c. Various projects have been undertaken concerning bulletproof jackets, World Space radios and broadcasts for troop welfare, electronic surveillance systems and firing ranges and others.

d. Coordinated the activities of, and facilitated communication amongst, the three Central Detective Training schools of the bureau. Their performance was reviewed, fresh course of action prepared and future milestones laid down.

e. Research issues completed, pending and needed were discussed. A realistic plan is under consideration to address expectations.

f. Workshops and visits to prisons were arranged while identifying Tihar jail as a centre for practical learning with the first workshop planned in October. The prison policy draft was circulated to all DG prisons in the country in preparation for discussion and finalization at the national conference to be held in December.

g. A proposal for delegation of financial powers for research in correctional administration under a separate budget head has been forwarded to the MHA. Separately, an allocation of funds for preparation of AV [audio-visual] training material has also been proposed to the MHA.

5. The bureau reviewed past consulting reports and recommendations concerning restructuring of BPR&D as a department to meet its goals and objectives set out in its charter and found several inadequacies and handicaps. We will address these in the coming weeks.

I sent such a note every month. Not a single one was acknowledged by either office. Such was the indifference! Perhaps there was also a message in this, which was: ‘Why are you writing this? Where is the need? Keep quiet and accept the system as it is. Do not try changing the way we work here.’ But when I once again did not reconcile myself to the persisting stagnation, it was considered a defiance of sorts (as not being part of the system). Which is why the often heard statement, ‘when you cannot be a part of the system, why do you not get out?’

To top it all, knowing fully well how ill-equipped the bureau was, the same home minister (who later on lost his job) directed me to put together a comprehensive and well-researched project to set up a police university for him, when the bureau was starved of all that was necessary to fulfil the charter. (At some stage I even smelt a self-serving, political agenda in this move and I felt that I was perhaps brought here to serve this very purpose.) When I asked for at least some minimal additional resource to work on the project, my request was turned down. I was asked to do so from within the existing manpower. Upon this, when I had the courage to tell the minister that the bureau would not be able to do justice to the task, now that I knew its capacity, he turned to the Union home secretary (my boss), present in the meeting, to do the needful. The home secretary willingly obliged the minister (instead of helping me and suggesting that I may get some additional help, however temporary). At the end of the meeting he (the HS) asked all of us to come to his office. There, he started to arbitrarily